



Anthem of the Seas — 7-Night Alaska

Round-trip from Seattle (Pier 91)

Ship: Anthem of the Seas · **Sailing from:** Pier 91, Seattle · **Cabin:** _____

A condensed Voyage Pack from [In the Wake](#) — the essentials in three pages. The full pack covers cabins, packing, budget, ship orientation, Alaska layering strategy, ports in depth, and Royal's quirks.

Day by day

#	Day	Port	Hours ashore	Tender	The one thing
1	Mon	Seattle — embarkation	board 11:30 AM – 3:30 PM; depart 4–5 PM	—	All-aboard 3:30 PM. Sailaway past Elliott Bay; Mt. Rainier south on clear days.
2	Tue	Cruising the Inside Passage	—	—	Settling-in day; first scenery. Bring binoculars to the upper deck.
3	Wed	Sitka	7:00 AM – 3:00 PM	yes	Sitka National Historical Park totem trail (free, 30-min walk) or sea-otter tour (\$210).
4	Thu	Skagway	7:00 AM – 8:30 PM (long!)	—	White Pass railway (~\$155 advance, \$165 day-of) or dog-sledding glacier helicopter (~\$650 splurge).
5	Fri	Endicott Arm + Dawes Glacier	scenic cruising AM	—	All-day deck day. Full layers. Dawes glacier approach 8–11 AM typically.
6	Sat	Juneau	10:00 AM – 9:00 PM	—	Mendenhall: Blue Bus Glacier Express ~\$90 r/t or Capital Transit city bus ~\$4 each way. Mt. Roberts Tramway / whale watching alternatives.
7	Sun	Victoria, BC	6:00 PM – 11:59 PM	—	Short evening stop. Inner Harbour walk; Parliament Buildings lit at night. Passport required.
8	Mon	Seattle — debarkation	off by 10:00 AM	—	Port Valet if eligible; bag ship-to-airline. See page 2.

The Alaska packing rule is layering. Thermal base, fleece mid, waterproof shell. Skip the umbrella (coastal wind blows them inside out — a hooded shell is superior).

Endicott Arm runs 10–15°F colder than the previous day's ports — the glacier face creates its own cold-air pool. Hand warmers earn their place.

Currency aboard: USD. **Auto-gratuity:** ~\$18.50/day per person; verify if pre-paid.

Decide before you board. Run the [drink-calculator](#) on your real drinking pattern, the [budget-calculator](#) for the total-fare picture, and the [tipping-calculator](#) for auto-grats + cash tips — mid-sail upgrades cost more per day and give you fewer days of usage.

Getting to the ship — and getting home

Arrival: Sunday recommended, Monday required

Sunday — fly into SEA. Same-day flights to a 4:30 PM Monday all-aboard are risky given Seattle weather. Sunday-night hotel in Downtown, Belltown, or Queen Anne puts you walking-distance to coffee Monday morning.

Monday — embarkation.

- **Terminal: Pier 91, Port of Seattle** (on the Magnolia/Interbay waterfront — NOT Pier 66 where NCL/MS/Princess board).
- **Sea-Tac (SEA) → Pier 91:** Uber/Lyft 25–35 min, \$40–55.
- **If driving:** Pier 91 parking garage ~\$30/day. Bring proof of cruise reservation.
- **Embark window:** 11:30 AM – 4:30 PM. **All-aboard 3:30 PM.** Ship departs ~4:00–5:00 PM.
- **Royal app online check-in** before arrival — completes faster than paper.

Day 8 debark and the trip home

- **The night before:** bags in the hall with color-coded tag by ~11 PM.
- **6:30 AM:** Bags off ship to terminal.
- **7:00 – 9:30 AM:** Walk-off in waves; self-disembark starts ~7 AM.
- **10:00 AM (latest):** All passengers off.

Port Valet — use it. Port of Seattle’s free service transfers your checked bag from ship directly to your final-destination airline check-in. Walk off Anthem with only your carry-on; bag meets you at home. Sign-up mid-cruise (Day 5 or 6 — watch the daily program). **The single most useful Seattle post-cruise tip.**

Getting from Pier 91 to SEA. Uber/Lyft \$40–55, 30–40 min. Pier 91 is NOT walkable to a Link light rail station like Pier 66 is — you’re committed to Uber/Lyft/taxi or a shuttle.

Airport-arrival timing.

Flight	Leave Pier 91 by
Domestic, after 4 PM	1:30 PM
International, after 6 PM	2:30 PM

SEA TSA lines run 30–60 min during Monday-afternoon cruise return.

Areas of interest during the cruise

On the ship — Anthem spots worth knowing

- **The Observation Lounge** — heated, glass-roofed, panoramic. Sunrise coffee here is the day's best 30 minutes; busy mid-morning during glacier.
- **The North Star** — observation pod that rises 300 ft above the deck on a glass-walled arm. Free with reservation; book Day 1 in the Royal app.
- **SeaPlex** — bumper cars, roller skating, basketball; the indoor activity zone for rainy sea days.
- **Solarium** — adults-only glass-roofed pool. Quietest in Alaska.
- **Two70°** — wraparound aft glass lounge with morphing video walls; the evening show venue.
- **The Bionic Bar** — robot bartenders. Touristy but worth one drink.

Sea-day priorities (Day 2)

1. **Sunrise coffee in the Observation Lounge** — the trip's best 30 minutes.
2. **Book North Star slot for tomorrow's glacier day** — do it Day 1 if possible, otherwise Day 2 morning.
3. **Mandara Spa thermal-suite day pass** — sea-day morning intro rate.
4. **Royal Caribbean app port talk for Sitka** — knows the tender timing and shore options.
5. **Specialty dining reservation** for the second half of the week.

Theme nights (rotating across the week)

Four themed evenings on this sailing: **80s Night** (leg warmers, neon), **70s Night** (bell-bottoms, sequins, disco), **Caribbean Night** (tropical/floral, on the Royal Promenade), and **Let's Dance Street Party** (all-white outfit). Participation is optional. **Smartest packing move: one all-white outfit** (works for Street Party + doubles as smart-casual) + **one bright accessory** (scarf, sunglasses, sequined top) that gestures toward 70s/80s/tropical. Specific nights are set in the *Cruise Compass* once aboard.

Day 5 — the Endicott Arm + Dawes Glacier hours

Best deck spots:

- **Your own balcony** (warm coffee, your own pace) if you have one.
- **Observation Lounge** — heated, glass-roofed.
- **Solarium** — heated, partial outdoor.
- **Deck 5 Promenade** — open-air, wind protection on the leeward side.

Pack for the rail: thermal, fleece, waterproof shell, hat, gloves, scarf, hand warmers, hot coffee in a thermal mug, binoculars.

Specialty dining picks

- **Chops Grille** — steakhouse, Royal's standard.
- **Jamie's Italian** — Jamie Oliver pasta and pizza; family-friendly.
- **Wonderland** — Royal's "imaginative cuisine" tasting menu; the splurge experience.
- **Izumi** — Japanese; sushi + hibachi rooms.

Port-day picks (one each)

- **Sitka** — totem trail at Sitka National Historical Park (free, 30 min). Pair with St. Michael's Cathedral and the Sheldon Jackson Museum.
- **Skagway** — White Pass Summit railway (~\$155 advance / \$165 day-of via wpyr.com direct; ~3 hrs) is the iconic Skagway ride. Or dog-sledding helicopter trip (~\$650) as the splurge.
- **Juneau** — Mendenhall Glacier: Blue Bus Glacier Express ~\$90 r/t (M&M Tours), Capital Transit city-bus combo ~\$4 each way (budget option), or whale-watching with Harv & Marv's (~\$150) — humpback season peaks Jun–Sep. Mt. Roberts Tramway is the third option.
- **Victoria** — Inner Harbour walk + dinner ashore. 4-hour evening stop; don't overplan.

Photo spots worth knowing

- **Sailaway from the Solarium** — Mt. Rainier on clear days.
- **Sitka totem trail** — old-growth forest at 10 AM has the best light.
- **Dawes Glacier face from the Observation Lounge** — ice fills the windows.
- **North Star pod over Endicott Arm** — booked in the Royal app.
- **Victoria Inner Harbour at night** — Parliament Buildings illuminated.

Need an at-home emergency handoff card? Separate one-page doc available from [In the Wake](#). The full Voyage Pack is the unabridged companion document. Soli Deo Gloria.